

Unit 3 House and Home



本单元主要讨论家庭问题和居住环境

Part 1 Words in Context

Passage 1: Should Children Do Housework? U3-1

Children should do housework. That seems to be a **controversial** idea, though not everyone will **admit** it. Some parents would **declare** that their children are too busy for housework. Many would **assign** housework or say they believe in the children, but the housework simply doesn't get done.



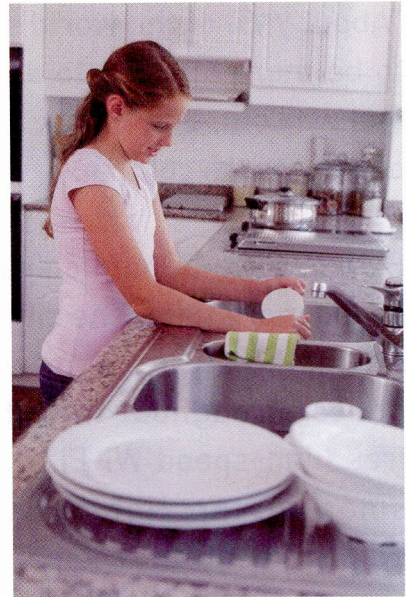
That's a problem. For starters, doing housework is good for children. Being a part of the **routine** of running a household helps children develop an awareness of the needs of others while developing their emotional **well-being**.

The **discovery** of one small study done over a **period** of 25 years found that the best **predictor** for success of adults in their mid-20s was whether they **participated** in household tasks at age 3 or 4. Those early shared responsibilities **extended** to a sense of responsibility in other areas of their lives.

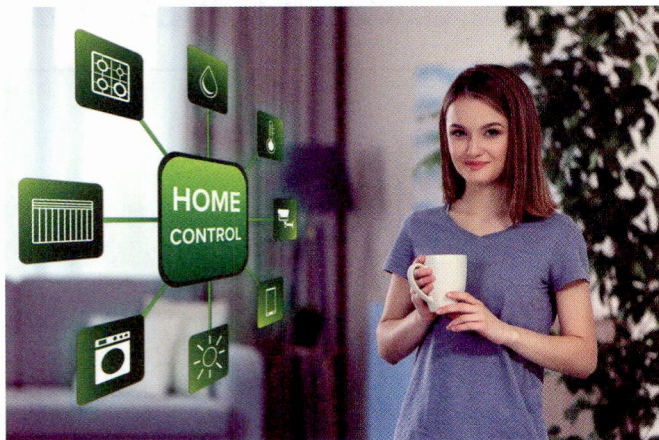
Despite the benefits of having children do **chores** around the house, few kids are actually doing much around the house at all. In a survey of 1,000 American adults, 75 percent said they believed **regular** housework made kids "more responsible". However, while 82 percent reported having done housework regularly while growing up, only **slightly** over 55 percent of those with children said they **required** to do housework.

Sports and homework are not get-out-of-housework-free cards. The goal, after all, is to raise adults who can **balance** a caring role in their families and communities with whatever lifetime **achievement** goals they choose. Housework teaches that balance.

What should you do when getting children to do housework? Accept no excuses. Don't worry if you must repeat yourself over and over again. If you're **spending** more time getting the child to do this job than it would take to do it yourself, then you're doing it right. Can an **allowance** help? Maybe. But if you're trying to teach kids to share the responsibility of a home, then paying them for routine housework does not send the right message. Just tell them if they don't want to live in an **untidy** room, they must do their share.



Passage 2: Smart Cities



Would you like to live in a city where buildings turn the lights off and say **good night** to you, and self-driving cars will find the nearest parking space themselves? Although it might sound a little far from you, living in a "smart" city like this could happen **sooner** than you think.

Great changes have **taken place** in towns that we have lived in for **centuries**, while completely new cities are being built. One such place is the city of Songdo (韩国城市). In every home there will be a "telepresence **system**—allowing users to **control** the heating and locks, take part in video meetings, turn up or down the **soundtrack** and **receive** education, health care and **government** services. Around the city, **escalators** will only move when someone is on them, and offices and schools will all be **connected** to the system.

The great mind behind Songdo is from the **company** Cisco. In fact, technology companies around the world such as IBM, Siemens and Microsoft are already in the **business**.